

— MARKETING STRATEGY • 2026

A wee plan, *properly built.*

A complete website, lead-capture funnel, and email + SMS strategy for Saltire Soft Play — one independent business, one branch, one growing database of regulars. Designed and delivered by Meere Marketing on the IVO Systems platform.

PREPARED FOR

Saltire Centre Ltd

PREPARED BY

Meere Marketing

PLATFORM

IVO Systems

DATE

May 2026

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The plan in one page.

Saltire Soft Play is independent, well-loved (4.6/5 on Tripadvisor), and largely walk-in driven. The opportunity is to capture the parents who already walk through the door, build a permission-based database, and bring them back — predictably and profitably — through a low-cost email and SMS programme delivered through IVO Systems.

What we're building

A new website (saltirecentre.co.uk) replacing the existing one — built for mobile, optimised for local search, with party booking enquiry flow integrated through IVO. The site becomes the destination for everything the campaign drives traffic to.

How we'll grow the database

A QR code at the front desk with an irresistible offer (free entry, free coffee & scone, BOGOF off-peak — owner's choice). One scan = a permission-marketing contact added to the IVO database, ready to be nurtured for years.

How we'll bring them back

Weekly emails from IVO covering school holidays, off-peak promos, party news and seasonal moments. SMS reserved for high-leverage triggers only — birthdays, exclusive offers, last-minute fills — because SMS is ~12× the cost of email per send.

What it costs

Email is effectively free at this scale (\$10 ≈ 7,400 emails). SMS is \$0.0166 per segment — affordable as long as you stay disciplined about emojis and the £ symbol (which can triple costs). Detailed breakdown later in this document.

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The foundation everything sits on.

Before any campaign can work, the destination has to be right. The new site replaces the existing saltirecentre.co.uk entirely — same domain, properly modern build — and becomes where every QR scan, every email click, every SMS link lands.

What's been built

Seven pages, mobile-first

Home, Soft Play, Parties, Exclusive Hire, Café, About, Contact. Every page designed for a parent on their phone — chunky tap targets, fast load, clean reading.

Search-engine optimised

Each page has unique titles, meta descriptions, canonical URLs, Open Graph cards, and Schema.org structured data (LocalBusiness, Service, FAQ, Restaurant) so Google can show rich results.

Two parties pages, both pushed

Regular party (£17/child, min 10) and Exclusive Hire (£17/child, min 20, whole-venue closure) get equal commercial weight, each with its own dedicated landing page.

Built for IVO integration

The party-enquiry section is wired to receive an IVO availability widget + form. Submissions trigger automated parent confirmation, internal team alert, and CRM lead capture.

SEO baked in from day one

The current saltirecentre.co.uk site gets organic search traffic for "soft play Edinburgh" and similar terms. The new build keeps and strengthens that traffic with:

- **Local SEO signals** — full address (EH22 4AD), phone, opening hours, area-served all marked up in Schema.org so Google Maps and the local pack pick them up.
- **FAQ schema on the parties page** — turns common questions into rich-result answers in Google search.
- **Aggregate review rating** — the 4.6/5 from Tripadvisor is structured so Google can display it in search results.
- **robots.txt and sitemap.xml** — full site map indexed and crawlable.
- **Page speed** — single CSS file, no heavy frameworks, Google Fonts preconnected — built to load fast on mobile, especially on 4G.

Every email, every SMS, every QR scan eventually points back to the website. If the site is slow, ugly, or fails on a mobile, the whole funnel leaks. We've engineered against that.

Domain, launch, and what happens to the existing site.

The new site replaces the old one entirely

The current saltirecentre.co.uk site is dated, mentions football services that Saltire no longer offers, and doesn't render well on mobile. The new build deploys to the same domain — visitors don't change anything, parents who Google "Saltire Soft Play" land on the new site automatically.

Football references removed

The old site still markets 5-a-side / 7-a-side football and uses the email saltiresoccer@outlook.com. The new site treats Saltire as a soft-play-and-parties business. The email decision (keep vs migrate to a domain email) is parked for end-of-project.

I

PAGES AT A GLANCE

- **Home** — Hero, prices snapshot, parties teaser
- **Soft Play** — Frame vs under-3, full pricing, rules
- **Parties** — Regular vs Exclusive overview
- **Exclusive Hire** — Whole-venue pricing & FAQ
- **Café** — Menu by category + PDF download
- **About** — Story, values, reviews
- **Contact** — Form, hours, directions

How the website fuels the campaign

SEARCH

Parent Googles "soft play near Edinburgh"

Schema markup, local SEO, and the 4.6/5 rating help Saltire show up in the local map pack and organic results.

VISIT
SITE

Lands on saltirecentre.co.uk

Sees prices, hours, photos, parties — decides whether to walk in or book a party enquiry. Mobile-first, fast, friendly.

WALK
IN

Visits the venue, sees the QR at reception

Offer pulls them into the database (next section). They've now been captured for life of contact (with consent).

ENGAGE

Receives welcome series, weekly emails, occasional SMS

Stays warm. The next school-holiday week, the next quiet Tuesday, the next exclusive party they need — Saltire is top of mind.

Becomes a regular, books a party, refers friends

RETURN

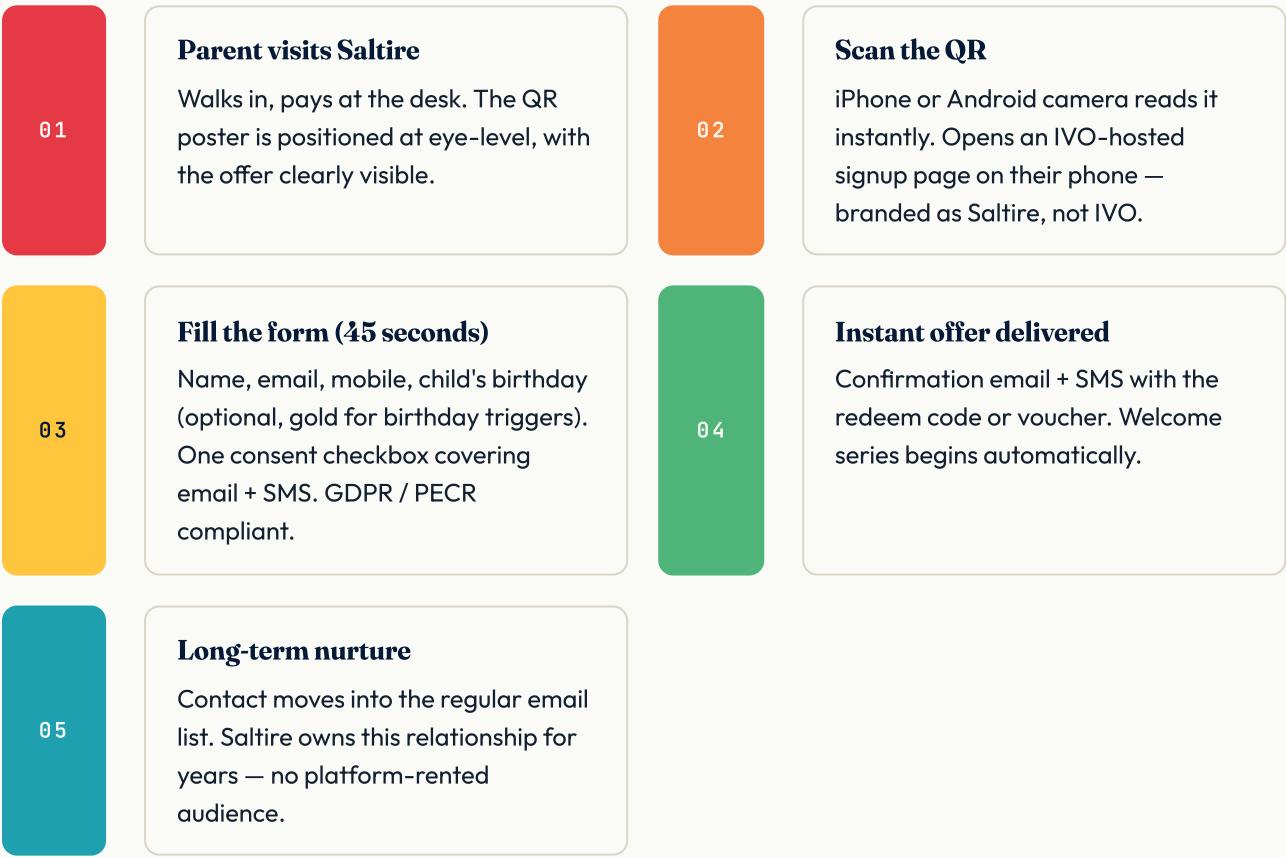
Loyalty card multiplies their lifetime value. Regular customers are the engine of the business — campaign keeps that engine fed.

03 LEAD CAPTURE

The QR code is the cheapest sales rep you'll ever hire.

A printed QR code at the front desk, a compelling offer to scan it, and an IVO-built signup form. Once it's set up, it works 365 days a year. Every parent who walks in is a chance to add a permission-marketed contact to the database.

The mechanic, in five steps



The lead magnet — owner's call

The offer behind the QR is the single biggest lever in this entire system. We recommend Saltire pick one of the following based on what the business needs most:

OFFER	COST PER SIGNUP	BEST FOR	PULL STRENGTH
Free entry, first visit	£8.00 - £9.50	Maximum signups, fastest list growth	★★★★★
BOGOF off-peak weekday	£6.50 - £8.00	Filling Mon–Thu quiet slots	★★★★☆

OFFER	COST PER SIGNUP	BEST FOR	PULL STRENGTH
Free child entry with paying child	£6.50 – £9.50	Sibling groups, families with multiple kids	★★★★☆
£3 off next visit	~£3.00	Controlled discount, repeat-visit incentive	★★★★☆
Free hot drink + scone	~£3.00 – £4.00	Café upsell hook, low risk	★★☆☆☆
Loyalty card boost (2 free stamps)	~£0 (deferred)	Building list cheaply, no upfront cost	★★☆☆☆

RECOMMENDATION

Start with **BOGOF off-peak weekday** for the first 90 days. It pulls hard, fills the quiet slots Saltire needs to fill anyway, and limits the cost-per-signup because the second child entry would otherwise be empty space. Review and switch if needed.

The QR poster — what we put on the wall.

Design principles

- **Big QR code**, ideally 4 cm minimum, scannable from a metre away.
- **One-line offer** — "Free child entry on your next visit" — readable from across the desk.
- **Brand colours** — navy + yellow + the Saltire wordmark, so it looks like Saltire, not a generic ad.
- **Tiny print on the bottom** — terms (one visit per family, etc.) and the standard GDPR opt-in line.

Where it goes

Three placements, escalating visibility:

- A4 sign at **front desk** — primary placement, everyone sees it on entry.
- Table-tent in the **café** — second touch while parents have their coffee.
- Tear-off card at the **exit** — last reminder if they didn't scan on the way in.



COMPLIANCE BUILT IN

The IVO signup form is configured for full UK marketing compliance:

- **GDPR consent** — explicit, unticked-by-default checkbox covering both email and SMS marketing.
- **PECR for SMS** — separate consent for SMS as required for direct-to-mobile marketing.
- **Confirmable double opt-in** available if Saltire wants the extra layer.
- **Unsubscribe link** in every email; STOP keyword for SMS.
- **Audit trail** in IVO showing exactly when and how each contact opted in.

What we capture, and why each field matters

FIELD	REQUIRED	WHY WE COLLECT IT
First name	Yes	Personalised emails ("Hi Sarah") perform 26 % better on average.
Email	Yes	Primary nurture channel. Cheapest delivery cost.
Mobile	Yes	SMS for high-leverage moments. Also a backup if email bounces.
Child's birth month	Optional	Triggers an automated "your wee one is turning X — fancy a party?" email a month before. High-converting.
Postcode (first half)	Optional	Helps Saltire understand catchment and target local Facebook ads later.

FIELD	REQUIRED	WHY WE COLLECT IT
Marketing consent	Yes	Required for legal compliance. Unticked by default.

Email is the workhorse. Quiet, cheap, and relentless.

For a small soft play with a strong local catchment, email is the single most cost-effective marketing channel that exists. At \$0.00135 per email, \$10 of budget delivers ~7,400 messages. It's effectively free at our list size, so the limiting factor is content quality, not cost.

The recommended cadence

SEND	FREQUENCY	AUDIENCE	GOAL
Welcome series	3 emails over 14 days	New signups	Convert into first repeat visit
Weekly newsletter	1 / week	Whole list	Stay top of mind, drive footfall
Birthday trigger	Auto, 1 month before child birthday	Contacts with birth month	Book a party
School holiday primer	~6 / year (each school holiday)	Whole list	Pre-fill the diary for half-terms
Win-back	After 60 days inactive	Lapsed contacts	Get them back through the door
Exclusive-hire spotlight	Quarterly	Higher-engagement segment	Drive exclusive party leads

Content themes that work for soft plays

Off-peak nudges

"Tuesdays are £6.50 not £8 — pop in any quiet day this week." Drives footfall into Mon–Thu.

School-holiday plans

"Edinburgh schools are off all next week — here's why Saltire is your sanity-saver."

Behind the scenes

"Our team, our story, why we keep the place spotless." Builds the small-business connection.

Café specials

"New scones on the menu this week. Come in for a coffee on us if you scan the QR."

Party reminders

"4–6 weeks until your wee one's birthday — here are dates we still have free."

Loyalty wins

"You're 2 stamps off a free entry — treat yourself this weekend." Pure repeat driver.

A NOTE ON TONE

Every email goes out as Saltire — the tone is the same friendly, parent-first, small-business voice the website uses. IVO is the platform underneath; the parent never sees it.

The 14-day welcome series — concrete example.

Three emails over two weeks turn a fresh QR signup into a warm contact who actually clicks future emails. This is automation that runs once and runs forever.

DAY 0 • WITHIN 2 MINUTES OF QR SCAN

Email 1 — "Welcome to Saltire — here's your offer"

Confirms the offer they signed up for, gives the redeem code or voucher, and a one-line intro to who Saltire is. Single CTA: "Bring it in next time you visit." Sent automatically by IVO the moment the form is submitted.

DAY 3

Email 2 — "What makes Saltire different"

Short, friendly. Why it's independent and family-run. The separate under-3 area. The Lavazza coffee. The free parking. Photos of the venue. Soft pitch: "Come back soon — we'd love to see you again."

DAY 10

Email 3 — "If you're thinking about a party..."

Warm pitch for the parties. Both packages (regular and exclusive) explained briefly with prices. CTA: "Check a date for your party →" linking to the parties page on the website. This is the highest-revenue email in the welcome series.

DAY 14 ONWARD

Joins the regular weekly newsletter

Now they're part of the main list, getting the weekly send like everyone else. The welcome series has done its job.

WHY THREE EMAILS, NOT SEVEN

More isn't better. Soft play parents are busy. A tight three-email welcome respects their inbox and trains them to actually open the weekly newsletter that follows. Diminishing returns kick in fast past three.

SMS is the sniper rifle. Use it sparingly, use it well.

SMS open rates are around 98 %, vs roughly 25–30 % for email. But SMS costs ~12× more per send, and one rogue emoji can triple the price of a single message. We treat SMS as a high-leverage tool used only when the moment justifies the spend.

First — what is a "segment"?

SMS is billed per **segment**, not per message. A segment is the unit your network bills against. The number of segments depends on the message length and the characters used.

ENCODING	CHARACTERS ALLOWED (SINGLE MESSAGE)	CHARACTERS PER SEGMENT (MULTI-SEGMENT)	TRIGGERED BY
GSM-7 (standard)	160	153	Plain English text, basic punctuation
UCS-2 (Unicode)	70	67	Any emoji, curly quotes, em-dashes, accented letters (é, ñ)

So a 140-character all-text message is **1 segment**. The same message with one emoji becomes Unicode and is now **3 segments**. Same content. Three times the cost.

Good — 1 segment

Hi Sarah! Tuesdays are off-peak at Saltire — kids 3+ enter for £6.50 instead of £8. Pop in any time 9-5.30. Reply STOP to opt out.

140 chars 1 segment \$0.0166 per send

Costly — 3 segments

Hi Sarah! 🍷 Tuesdays are off-peak — kids 3+ for £6.50 instead of £8. Pop in 9-5.30. Reply STOP to opt out.

110 chars (Unicode) 3 segments \$0.0498 per send

⚠️ WATCH OUT FOR

The £ symbol is in the GSM-7 extension table — it counts as 2 characters towards the segment limit. A few £ signs near the boundary can quietly push you from 1 segment to 2. Curly quotes from Word ('like this') trigger Unicode and triple your cost. Stick to straight quotes.

When SMS earns its place.

Used for the right moments, SMS is the highest-converting channel a soft play has. Used for everything, it's the fastest way to burn through budget and get unsubscribed. Here's our recommended trigger list:

TRIGGER	WHEN IT FIRES	WHY SMS, NOT EMAIL
Birthday reminder	Auto, 4 weeks before child birthday	High emotional moment — needs immediate visibility, not buried in inbox
Party booking confirmation	Right after office calls back to confirm the date	Reassures parent that the booking is real. Email + SMS combo
Pre-party reminder	~48 hours before a confirmed party	Last-minute logistics: numbers, food choice, allergies. Must-read
Last-minute fill	Manual, on quiet weekday mornings	Same-day decision needed — email is too slow
Welcome offer redeem code	Immediately after QR signup	Parent wants to redeem on this very visit — phone in hand
Exclusive-hire alert	Quarterly, to high-engagement segment only	Bigger ticket — worth the spend on a smaller, warmer audience
Review request	Day after a party	SMS gets a 5× higher review-request response rate than email

What SMS should NOT be used for

- **Weekly newsletter** — that's email territory. Sending SMS weekly will burn the list and cost a fortune.
- **Café updates / behind-the-scenes** — too low-leverage for the spend.
- **"Just checking in"** — never send an SMS that doesn't have an action attached.
- **Anything with emojis or fancy punctuation** — see previous page. 3× cost overnight.

Plan for ~6 SMS per contact per year — birthday, two pre-party, one welcome offer, one review request, one win-back. At 1,000 contacts and 1 segment per message, that's ~\$100/year in SMS costs total. Very affordable when used disciplined.

06 COST PROJECTIONS

The numbers, at every list size.

Email and SMS economics scale linearly with list size and send frequency. The table below shows monthly costs at four list sizes, assuming our recommended cadence: 1 email/week + average 0.5 SMS/contact/month.

LIST SIZE	EMAILS / MONTH (~4)	EMAIL COST	SMS / MONTH (~0.5 PER CONTACT)	SMS COST	TOTAL MONTHLY
500	2,000	\$2.70	250	\$4.15	\$6.85
1,000	4,000	\$5.40	500	\$8.30	\$13.70
3,000	12,000	\$16.20	1,500	\$24.90	\$41.10
5,000	20,000	\$27.00	2,500	\$41.50	\$68.50
10,000	40,000	\$54.00	5,000	\$83.00	\$137.00

All figures based on \$0.00135 per email and \$0.0166 per SMS segment. Assumes plain-text messages (1 segment each). USD pricing through IVO Systems. Conversion to GBP at point of billing.

What this means in plain English

YEAR 1 (TARGET LIST ~1,500)

\$30

PER MONTH, ALL IN

Total annual marketing-platform spend ~ \$360 / £290. For a soft play turning over six figures, this is rounding-error level. The cost of one busy Saturday afternoon.

YEAR 3 (TARGET LIST ~5,000)

\$70

PER MONTH, ALL IN

By the time the list compounds, the per-contact cost actually drops because of email's near-zero marginal cost. Marketing platform spend is still under £700/year.

THE ECONOMICS

One additional party booking per month (£170+ minimum on a regular party) covers the entire annual platform spend. The campaign breaks even on a single conversion and runs into pure profit from there.

From scan to regular — exactly what happens.

Following a single parent — call her Sarah — from the moment she scans the QR at reception, through 90 days of automated and broadcast messaging, to the point she's a returning regular. Every touchpoint is built and configured in IVO once, then runs on its own.



DAY 0 • 14:23 • AT THE VENUE

Sarah scans the QR at the front desk

She fills in name, email, mobile, and her son's birth month. Ticks the consent box. Submits.



DAY 0 • 14:24

Welcome email arrives. SMS arrives.

Email confirms the offer with a redeem code. SMS does the same in 140 characters. Sarah redeems before she leaves the venue.



DAY 3

Welcome email 2 — "What makes Saltire different"

Builds the brand connection. Links to the About page. No hard sell.



DAY 10

Welcome email 3 — Soft pitch on parties

Both packages introduced. Links to the parties page.



DAY 14

Joins weekly newsletter

First Friday-morning send. Topic this week: "Half-term plans — opening times, off-peak prices, café specials."



DAY 21

Sarah comes back for her second visit

Pays full off-peak price. Redeems no offer this time. The campaign is now compounding — she's a real regular, not just a free-entry tourist.



DAY 28

SMS — birthday reminder

"Hi Sarah, your wee one is one month from turning 5 — fancy throwing the party here? Reply YES and we'll call." High-leverage trigger.



DAY 35

Sarah replies YES

Office calls within the day, books the party, takes the £100 deposit. Lifetime value of this contact has just leapt by £400+.

DAY 60

Pre-party SMS reminder + email

48 hours before the party. Reconfirms numbers, food choice, allergies. Reduces last-minute admin.

DAY 63

Party day. Post-party review request (next day)

SMS day after the party with one-tap link to a Google review. Strong open + click rate.

DAY 90

Sarah is in the warm regular segment

2 visits + 1 party in the books. Receiving weekly newsletter. Reviewer. Future referral source. Estimated 12-month lifetime value: £350+.

Three options. Pick the one that fits.

Marketing intensity is a dial, not a switch. Saltire can start light and ramp up, or start at full pace from day one. We recommend starting at **Standard** — meaningful contact without overwhelming the inbox.

TIER 01 • LITE

~\$10/mo

For testing the waters. Keeps the lights on — limited proactive marketing, automation only.

- › Welcome series (auto)
- › Birthday triggers (auto)
- › Pre-party reminders (auto)
- › 1 newsletter / month
- › No SMS broadcast
- › QR + signup form active

Best for: First 30 days while building the list and seeing what's possible.

TIER 02 • STANDARD

RECOMMENDED

~\$30/mo

The default for a growing list of 1k–3k contacts. Real momentum, no fluff.

- › Welcome series (auto)
- › Birthday triggers (auto)
- › Pre-party reminders (auto)
- › 1 newsletter / week
- › ~6 SMS broadcasts / year
- › School-holiday primers
- › Win-back campaigns

Best for: The default. Most soft plays in the UK should sit here long-term.

TIER 03 • AGGRESSIVE

~\$70/mo

Heavier rotation, multi-channel, segmented. Suits a list of 5k+.

- › Everything in Standard
- › 2 newsletters / week (broadcast + segmented)
- › Monthly SMS broadcast
- › Segmented offers (regulars / lapsed / VIPs)
- › Quarterly exclusive-hire push
- › Dedicated retargeting flows

Best for: Year 2+ when the list is large and segmentation pays off.

NOTE: PLATFORM-COST ONLY

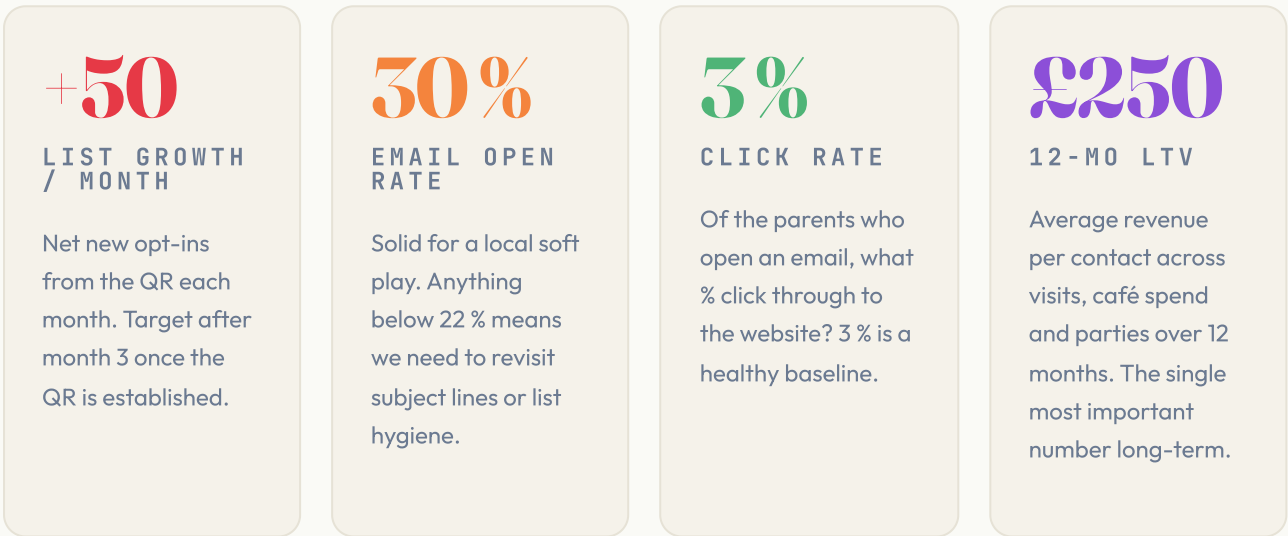
The figures above cover the IVO send-cost — what gets paid for emails and SMS. They do not include the Meere Marketing service fee for managing the campaign (writing copy, designing

emails, monitoring performance, building automations). That's quoted separately based on retainer scope.

What we measure, what we report.

Marketing without measurement is just expensive guessing. IVO captures everything; we surface the metrics that actually inform decisions and ignore the vanity ones.

The four numbers Saltire should care about



What we report monthly

METRIC	DESCRIPTION	TARGET
List size	Total active opt-ins	+50/mo Y1
List growth %	MoM growth, net of unsubscribes	5-10 %
Open rate	% of sent emails opened	25-35 %
Click rate	% of sent emails clicked	2-5 %
Unsubscribe rate	% per send opting out	< 0.5 %
QR scan → signup conversion	What % of scans complete the form	> 60 %
Party leads from email	Enquiries attributed to email/SMS	2-4 / mo
SMS segments sent	Cost-tracking metric	Within budget

METRIC	DESCRIPTION	TARGET
Top-performing email of the month	Used to inform next month's plan	Qualitative

THE REPORTING CADENCE

Monthly dashboard delivered by email on the 1st. Quarterly performance review meeting with Saltire. Annual strategic review to set the next year's targets and any structural changes.

10 NEXT STEPS

What we need from Saltire to launch.

Here's the punch list. Tick each item and we go live within four to six weeks of sign-off.

From Saltire

ITEM	WHY WE NEED IT	STATUS
Sign-off on this strategy	Locks in scope and tier choice	Awaiting
QR offer chosen	Drives the entire signup mechanic	Awaiting
Logo files (vector)	Replace placeholder type-marks on website & emails	Awaiting
Photos of the venue	Hero images, party visuals, café photography	Awaiting
Café menu PDF	Powers the Café page download button	Awaiting
Domain access	To switch saltirecentre.co.uk to the new build	Awaiting
Email decision	Domain email vs current Outlook address	Deferred to launch
Existing contact database	Any past parties, walk-ins, FB followers we can import (with consent)	Awaiting

Our delivery timeline



WEEK 1

Sign-off & setup

Strategy approved. IVO sub-account configured. Domain access shared. QR offer locked in.



WEEK 2

Website finalisation

Real photos and logo dropped in. Cafe menu PDF uploaded. Site goes live on saltirecentre.co.uk.



WEEK 3

QR funnel built

Signup form, welcome series, birthday triggers, pre-party reminders all built and tested in IVO. QR poster designed and printed.

WEEK 4

Launch & first newsletter

QR poster goes up at front desk. First weekly newsletter sent. Reporting dashboard delivered to Saltire.

WEEKS 5-12

Optimisation

Watch the data. Adjust offers, subject lines, send times based on what's working. Add segmented automations as the list grows.

QUESTIONS OR WANT TO TALK IT THROUGH?

Get in touch: Jay @ Meere Marketing — jay@meere-marketing.com. Looking forward to building something proper for Saltire.